

Psalms 66

Come and See the Works of God

Come and see the works of God
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Make a joyful noise unto God, all ye lands:*
- 2 *Sing forth the honour of his name: make his praise glorious.*
- 3 *Say unto God, How terrible art thou in thy works! through the greatness of thy power shall thine enemies submit themselves unto thee.*
- 4 *All the earth shall worship thee, and shall sing unto thee; they shall sing to thy name. Selah.*
- 5 *Come and see the works of God: he is terrible in his doing toward the children of men.*
- 6 *He turned the sea into dry land: they went through the flood on foot: there did we rejoice in him.*
- 7 *He ruleth by his power for ever; his eyes behold the nations: let not the rebellious exalt themselves. Selah.*
- 8 *O bless our God, ye people, and make the voice of his praise to be heard:*
- 9 *Which holdeth our soul in life, and suffereth not our feet to be moved.*
- 10 *For thou, O God, hast proved us: thou hast tried us, as silver is tried.*
- 11 *Thou broughtest us into the net; thou laidst affliction upon our loins.*
- 12 *Thou hast caused men to ride over our heads; we went through fire and through water: but thou broughtest us out into a wealthy place.*
- 13 *I will go into thy house with burnt offerings: I will pay thee my vows,*
- 14 *Which my lips have uttered, and my mouth hath spoken, when I was in trouble.*
- 15 *I will offer unto thee burnt sacrifices of fatlings, with the incense of rams; I will offer bullocks with goats. Selah.*
- 16 *Come and hear, all ye that fear God, and I will declare what he hath done for my soul.*
- 17 *I cried unto him with my mouth, and he was extolled with my tongue.*
- 18 *If I regard iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear me:*
- 19 *But verily God hath heard me; he hath attended to the voice of my prayer.*
- 20 *Blessed be God, which hath not turned away my prayer, nor his mercy from me.*

2 · CONTEXT

A communal thanksgiving psalm inviting "all ye lands" to praise God for His awesome deeds and for personally answering the psalmist's own prayer after testing. Henry notes the shift from national praise (1–12) to individual testimony and vows fulfilled (13–20), a pattern of public worship rooted in private experience.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

"Make a joyful noise unto God, all ye lands... say unto God, How terrible art thou in thy works!... all the earth shall worship thee." Universal, exuberant praise is called for on the basis of God's fearsome, wonder-working reputation among all nations.

Verse 5-7

"Come and see the works of God... He turned the sea into dry land: they went through the flood on foot... He ruleth by his power for ever." The Exodus is remembered as ongoing proof of present, continuing divine government over rebellious nations.

Verse 8-12

"O bless our God, ye people... which holdeth our soul in life... thou, O God, hast proved us: thou hast tried us, as silver is tried... thou broughtest us out into a wealthy place." Testing and affliction are acknowledged honestly as God's own refining process, not meaningless suffering, ending in abundance.

Verse 13-15

"I will go into thy house with burnt offerings: I will pay thee my vows... I will offer bullocks with goats." Private vows made during trouble are now fulfilled publicly with costly, specific worship.

Verse 16-20

"Come and hear, all ye that fear God, and I will declare what he hath done for my soul... Verily God hath heard me... Blessed be God, which hath not turned away my prayer, nor his mercy from me." Personal testimony becomes public instruction, closing on assurance that sincere prayer is never ultimately refused.

4 • MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

National memory of God's mighty acts and personal testimony of answered prayer reinforce each other; testing by fire and water is acknowledged as God's refining work, and it issues in specific, costly worship and public testimony meant to instruct others who fear God.

Application for life today.

Recount concrete "works of God"—corporately remembered and personally experienced—as a discipline of praise, not vague sentiment. When reflecting on hard seasons, consider whether God was refining you like silver, not abandoning you. Turn private vows made in trouble into specific, fulfilled acts of worship, and be willing to "declare" to others what God has done for your soul.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What specific "works of God"—corporate or personal—could you "come and see" and recount today?

2. Looking back at a season of testing ("fire and water"), can you identify how God was refining you like silver?

3. Is there a vow or promise made during a hard season that you still need to "pay," as verse 13 describes?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).